

Workplace Considerations for the Pregnant Worker

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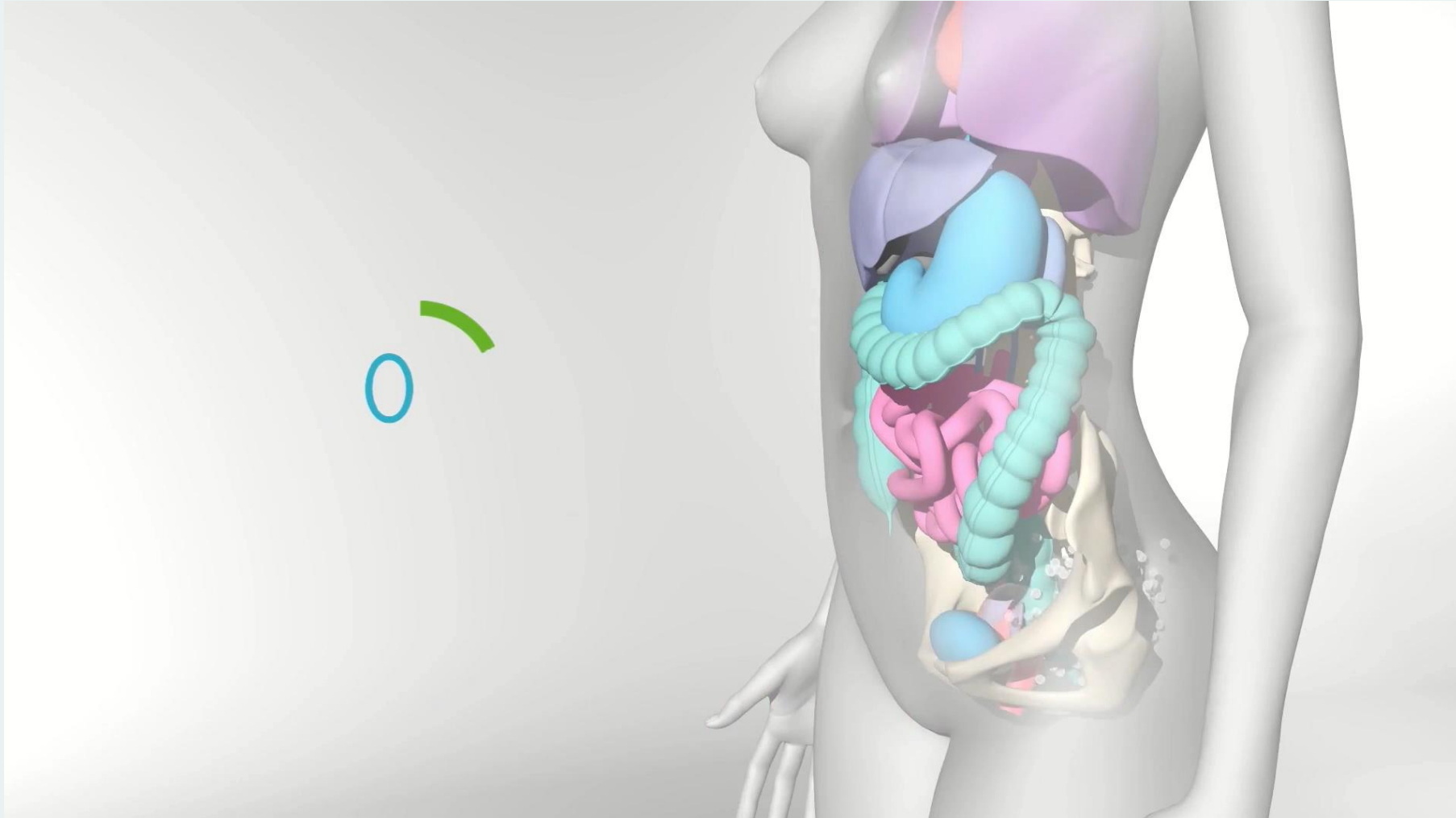
Background

- Historically laid off or transferred
- Pregnant workers are more common today
 - Often to full term
- Physical and physiological changes
- Poor conditions can result in:
 - Lower efficiency
 - Health risk to baby
- Medical leave is finite

Background



The Pregnant Body



The Pregnant Body



Solution

- Proactive
- Develop workstations and tasks beforehand
 - Physiological and anatomical changes
- Initial costs are greater, but more cost-effective in the long run

Heat Stress

- Caution even if acclimated
- Begin very early in the pregnancy



Cold Stress

- Properly fitting protective equipment
- Prevent cold stress early in pregnancy



Vibration

- Minimize exposure
- Vibration dampening padding or matting



Noise

- Minimize exposure to an eight-hour TWA of less than 85dBA
- Unexpected noises
- Loud noises
- Low-frequency noises
- Noise over 115 dBA (a chainsaw) can damage the fetus



High Humidity

- Slipping
- Poor gripping



Posture

- Reduce static and awkward postures
 - Reaches over 16"
 - Above shoulders
- Stand for less than two hours
 - Floor matting
 - Footrests
- Alternate standing/sitting
- Adjustable workstations
- Body dimension changes
- Regular breaks



Physical Exertion

- Minimize heavy work
 - Unless well-conditioned and approved
- Past 4 months should be agreed upon
- Less than 20-30lbs less than 12 times a day
- Eliminate reaches above shoulders and below waist



Long Hours

- Avoid rapidly rotating shifts
- Avoid work at night
 - Unless still sleeping at night
- Maximum of 40-hour weeks



Mental Stress

- Minimize paced work
- Minimize where no control
- Minimize mentally strenuous demands
 - Increased sensitivity
 - Increased fatigue



Reflect

- Take 3-5 minutes to reflect.
- How does your school/workplace score in all of these areas?
- What improvements can be made to plan for pregnant workers in the future?

Thank
you